Experiment – 9

Blueprint

Designing a Process Blueprint in Zoho Creator

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Application Name: Purchase Request / Procurement Application

Objective

To create a process Blueprint in Zoho Creator that represents the different stages of a purchase request and defines the transitions between them, ensuring that requests follow a consistent approval route.

Introduction

A Blueprint in Zoho Creator provides a visual way to define and manage a business process. A record stays in one stage at a time and can move to another stage only through a configured transition. These transitions are presented as actions to the user, and can represent approval, rejection, or a request for changes. The process structure helps ensure that each purchase request follows the required sequence and makes its progress easier to track.

Blueprint Components

Component	Description	Use in this Experiment
Blueprint	A complete process definition associated with a form	Approval blueprint linked to the Approval History form
Stage	A state occupied by a record during the process	Submitted, HOD Review, Finance Review, Procurement, Approved, Rejected, Revision Requested
Transition	An action that moves a record to another stage	Submit for HOD Review, Approve to Finance, Reject, Request Revision, Final Approval, Resubmit
Start	The entry point of the process	Start → Submitted

Table 9.1: Main components used in the Zoho Creator Blueprint.

Blueprint Design – Purchase Approval Process

The blueprint represents the path followed by a purchase request from submission to its final decision. The request first enters the Submitted stage, then moves to HOD Review and Finance Review before reaching Procurement. At review stages, the request may be rejected or returned for revision. A revised request can be resubmitted for further processing.

Current Stage	Transition	Next Stage	Type
Start	—	Submitted	Entry
Submitted	Submit for HOD Review	HOD Review	Forward
HOD Review	Approve to Finance	Finance Review	Forward
HOD Review	Reject	Rejected	End
HOD Review	Request Revision	Revision Requested	Return
Finance Review	Approve to Procurement	Procurement	Forward
Finance Review	Reject	Rejected	End
Finance Review	Request Revision	Revision Requested	Return
Procurement	Final Approval	Approved	End
Procurement	Reject	Rejected	End
Revision Requested	Resubmit	Submitted / process resumes	Return

Table 9.2: Stages and transitions of the purchase approval Blueprint.

Screenshot-Based Lab Record

The following screenshots show the Blueprint configuration in Zoho Creator, using the supplied reference images.

Screenshot 1 – Blueprint List

The Blueprints section displays the process definitions available in the application. In the reference, the Approval History form contains an enabled blueprint named Approval blueprint. The Budget, Department, Purchase Request, Purchase Request Items, and Vendor forms are shown without blueprints.

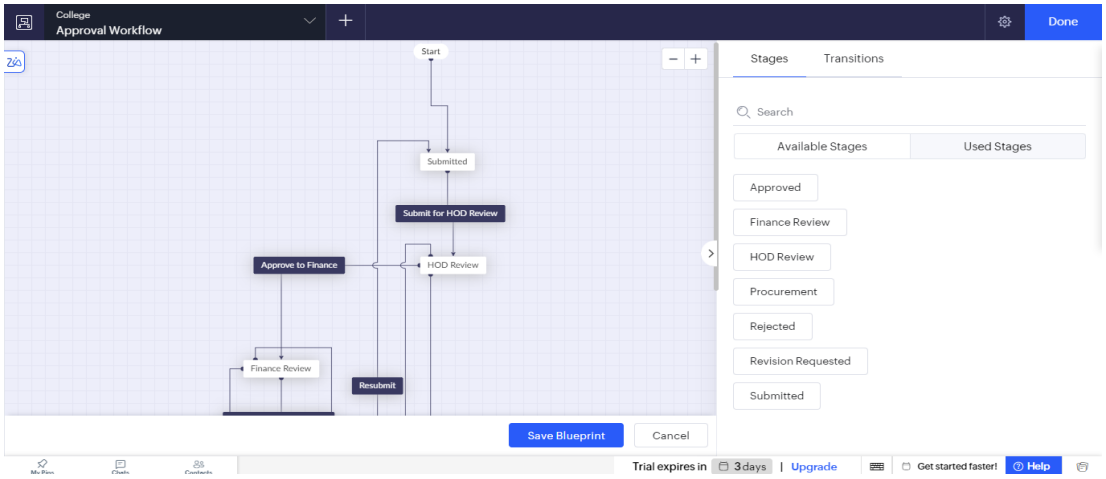


Figure 1: Blueprint list showing the enabled Approval blueprint.

Screenshot 2 – Blueprint Designer and Stages

The designer uses a canvas to show the route from the Start node through the defined stages. A side panel contains the Stages and Transitions tabs. Stages can be created and then placed on the canvas; the Used Stages list identifies the stages that have already been included in the approval process.

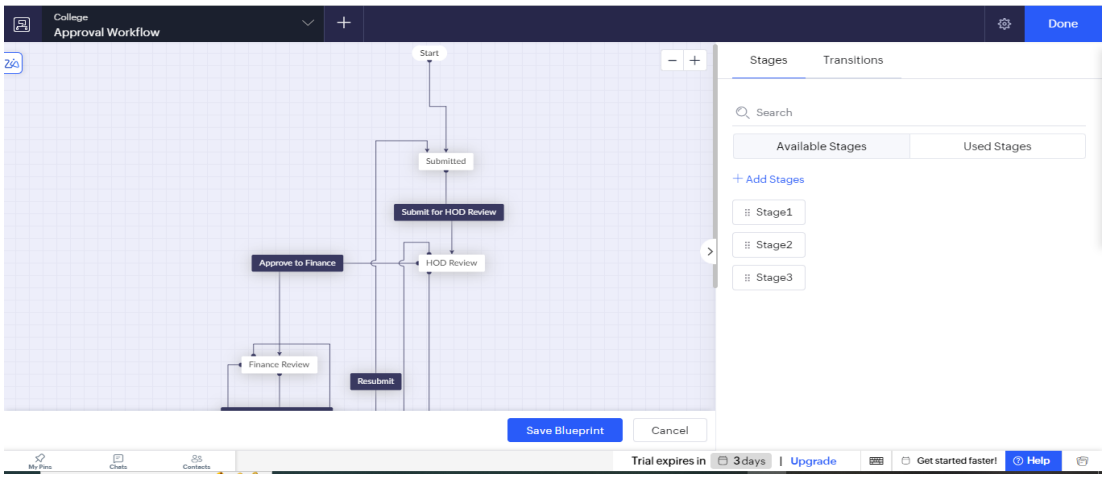


Figure 2: Blueprint designer and the stages used in the approval process.

Screenshot 3 – Transitions

The Transitions tab records the starting stage, the action displayed to the user, and the destination stage. The listed transitions allow a request to progress from HOD Review to Finance Review, then to Procurement, while also providing options to reject or request revision.

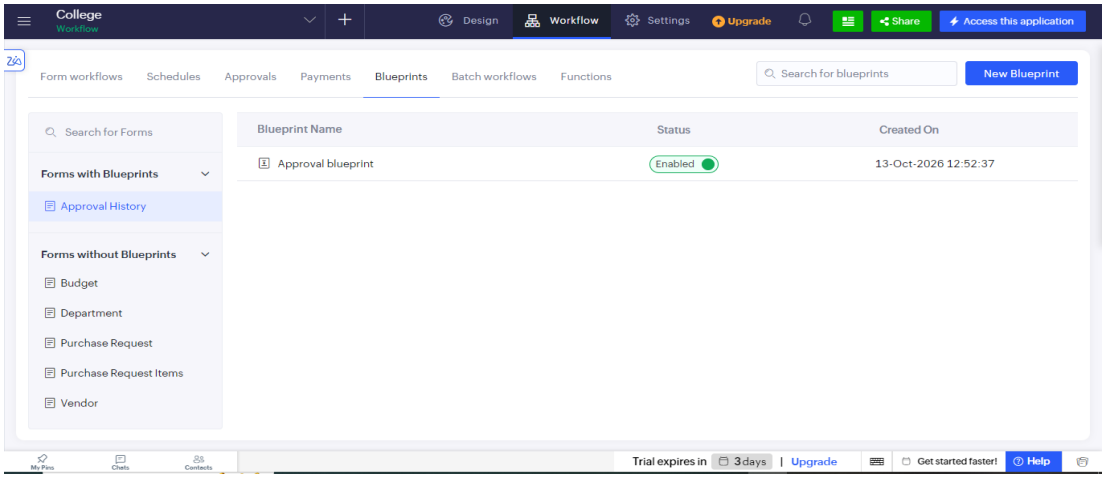


Figure 3: Transition list connecting the stages of the Approval blueprint.

Observation

The Blueprint models the purchase approval route using stages and transitions rather than requiring the routing sequence to be written as code. A request must follow the configured path, so it cannot move directly to Procurement without completing HOD and Finance review. Reviewers can approve, reject, or return a request for revision, and the resubmission path allows corrected requests to re-enter the process. This structure is visually understandable and can be modified by changing stages or transitions. Unlike a form workflow that reacts to an event, a Blueprint governs the next permitted step in a process.

Result

The Approval blueprint was designed for the Zoho Creator purchase request process. It defines the stages and transitions for submission, HOD review, Finance review, procurement, final approval, rejection, and revision, providing a consistent route for processing purchase requests.